Equiano: locations in chapters 1-2

The narrative moves from an African inland home to Barbados. The inland route and embarkation port are not named precisely.

ATLANTIC OVERVIEW



Scope: the geography of Equiano's account, not an independently verified itinerary. Modern borders provide orientation. Virginia and England enter in chapter III.

SOUTHEAST NIGERIA



The Niger and Benue are orientation features. Chapter II's large river is unnamed; this map does not identify it as the Niger.

BARBADOS



PLACES THE TEXT DOES NOT LET US PINPOINT

Essaka / Eboe: Equiano places his childhood home inland in Igbo country. Essaka's exact identification is disputed. No village coordinate is asserted here.

Tinmah: a named town with streams and a central pond. Modern identifications remain scholarly proposals. The other inland stops, large river, and embarkation port are unnamed.

Bridgetown: named at the end of chapter II. Captives are inspected and separated for sale. The dot locates the town, not a verified sale yard.

CHAPTER I: NAMES AND GEOGRAPHIC LIMITS

Guinea: Equiano's broad coastal term extends from Senegal to Angola. It is not the modern Republic of Guinea.

Benin: the historic kingdom centred on Benin City, in present-day Nigeria. It is distinct from the modern state labelled BENIN.

Abyssinia: a reference to the Ethiopian region. Equiano's suggestion that Benin extended that far is not a reliable political boundary. No such territory is drawn.

Water in the account: springs and brooks; Tinmah's pond; an unnamed large river; the Atlantic crossing.

Sources: Equiano, chapters I-II; Natural Earth 1:50m / 1:10m (public domain); Getty TGN; Yale eHRAF; Lovejoy (2024/25). Full ledger accompanies map.